In this chapter, you'll take a significant step toward expanding the blockchain ecosystem and enhancing the development skills you have acquired so far: graduating from hosting Dapps on a local test chain to a public chain. This step is indispensable to enable decentralized participants to access and interact with your Dapp. You'll learn about working with Infura by deploying the familiar blind auction and micropayment channel Dapps. For both deployments, Infura will provide scalable infrastructure for hosting the nodes, and Ropsten will serve as the public network. The focus will be on simulating multiple roles of participants in a decentralized network.

> **NOTE** You must complete chapter 7 to get the most out of this chapter.

8.1 Nodes and networks

When we consider applications such as email and messaging, most of us see only the user interface of the client (the email client, for example). Behind most applications are servers--application servers that manage the emails, store them, format, and filter them, and so on. Similarly, the nodes are servers for blockchain services, as you learned in chapter 6. The nodes manage blockchain-related operations. A network connects nodes. The operations on the network of nodes (chapter 1) are controlled by a protocol or a set of rules. Figure 8.1 is replicated here from chapter 1 to refresh the network-of-nodes concept.